Design *system.*

The visual language of Karam Shaar Advisory, recorded from the redesigned Services page so that it can be kept, changed in one place, and carried to other pages and platforms.

VERSION	PRINTED	THEMES	LANGUAGES
0.2 draft	12 October 2026	Night, day	English, Arabic

What this is, and how to read it.

A record of the design built for the redesigned Services page, written down so the same language can be reused on other pages and other platforms. It is a draft. The system is still being settled, and the last chapter lists what is open.

01 Principles What the design is for, and the order of emphasis 03

02 Colour Night and day palettes, roles, contrast 06

03 Type Three families, the scale, heading patterns, Arabic 10

04 Layout Container, rhythm, grids, breakpoints, the page 14

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06 Components Actions, inputs, navigation, cards, data, footer 19

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11 Upkeep Changing a value, what lives where, status, open questions 35

A Token index Every value in the token file 38

For the team

Each chapter opens with the idea and follows with the exact values. Read the openers to know the design. Read the pages behind them to build with it.

For designers and developers

Colours, sizes and tables in this book are printed from the token file, and the specimens are drawn by the page's own stylesheet. The book and the site cannot disagree, because one is made from the other.

For AI assistants

Start from `DESIGN.md` at the project root. Change values in `design-system/tokens.css`, then run `node design-system/build.mjs`. There is no need to read the whole page file to change a colour or a size.

RECORDED FROM

site/index.html

TOKENS

103 values

Principles

01

Evidence leads

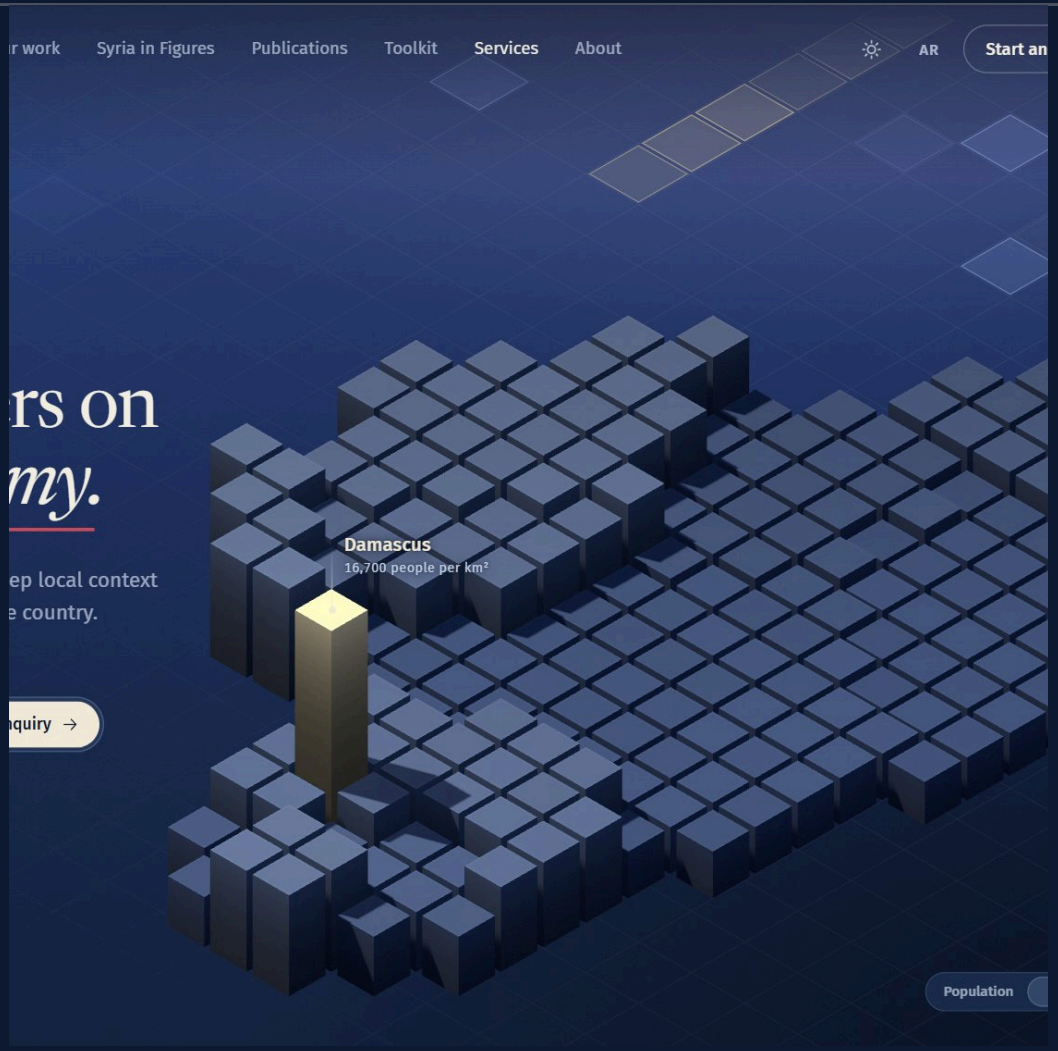
One field, one accent

Editorial, not promotional

Motion that settles

Two scripts, two lights

Only what is true



One voice

A research firm should look like its research: exact, calm, and easy to check. Every rule in this book follows from that.

Six principles.

These are the reasons behind the values in the rest of the book. When a new page or platform raises a question the book does not answer, answer it from here.

01

Evidence leads.

The firm sells analysis, so data is the picture. The block map of Syria, the row of figures and the firm's own publication covers do the work that photography does elsewhere.

In practice: no stock photographs and no decorative illustration. A picture is a map, a number, a chart or a real cover.

02

One field, one accent.

Deep navy carries the page. Cream is the only accent: it marks what can be pressed and what is selected. Rose appears once, as the line under the headline's key words.

In practice: if a second accent seems necessary, the layout is asking for hierarchy, not colour.

03

Editorial, not promotional.

Serif headlines set like a publication, written as sentences that end in a full stop. Wide margins, a calm measure, hairlines instead of boxes.

In practice: no small label above a heading, no coloured stripe down the side of a card, no card inside a card.

04

Motion that settles.

One spring with no bounce. Content rises once as it arrives and then stays still. Nothing loops to ask for attention.

In practice: every movement has a still form for visitors who ask for reduced motion, and the page reads the same without it.

05

Two scripts, two lights.

English and Arabic, night and day, are four equal states of one design. None of them is a translation or an afterthought of another.

In practice: a change is finished when it is right in all four. New copy arrives with its Arabic. New colour arrives with its day value.

06

Only what is true.

Rates, client names, counts and registration numbers come from the firm's own published record.

In practice: nothing is invented to fill a layout. A figure that is not yet confirmed is marked as a stand-in in the source until the real one arrives.

Hierarchy.

Four ladders decide what the eye meets first: the size of type, the strength of its ink, the lightness of the surface, and the weight of an action. Each has few steps, and a page uses them in order.

READING ORDER

1 **Clear answers on *Syria's economy.***

Headline: --fs-hero, one per page

2 **1,400+**

Figure: --fs-figure, --fs-price

3 **Four practice areas.**
One view of the economy.

Section heading: --fs-h2, second sentence dimmed

4 **Research and studies**

Card heading: --fs-h3, --fs-card-title

5 Market assessments, sector analysis and feasibility studies.

Body: --fs-body, --fs-lede, --fs-sub

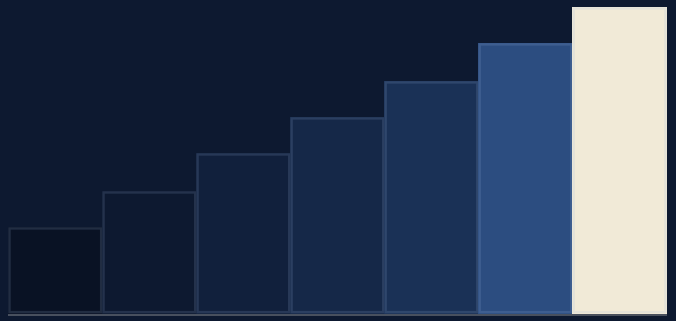
6 Cost and timeline follow scope

Meta: small text, 11.5 to 15.2 px

STRENGTH OF INK

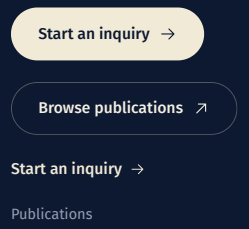
INK	TOKEN	USED FOR
Full	`--text`	Headings, figures, the paragraph being read
Clear	`--lit`	Copy inside cards, client names
Supporting	`--muted`	Ledes, card copy, labels, nav links
Faint	`--faint`	Second half of a heading, legal lines

DEPTH BY LIGHTNESS: NEARER IS LIGHTER



Surfaces step from the page edge up to the cream card. Shadow is kept for the three places where one thing physically overlaps another.

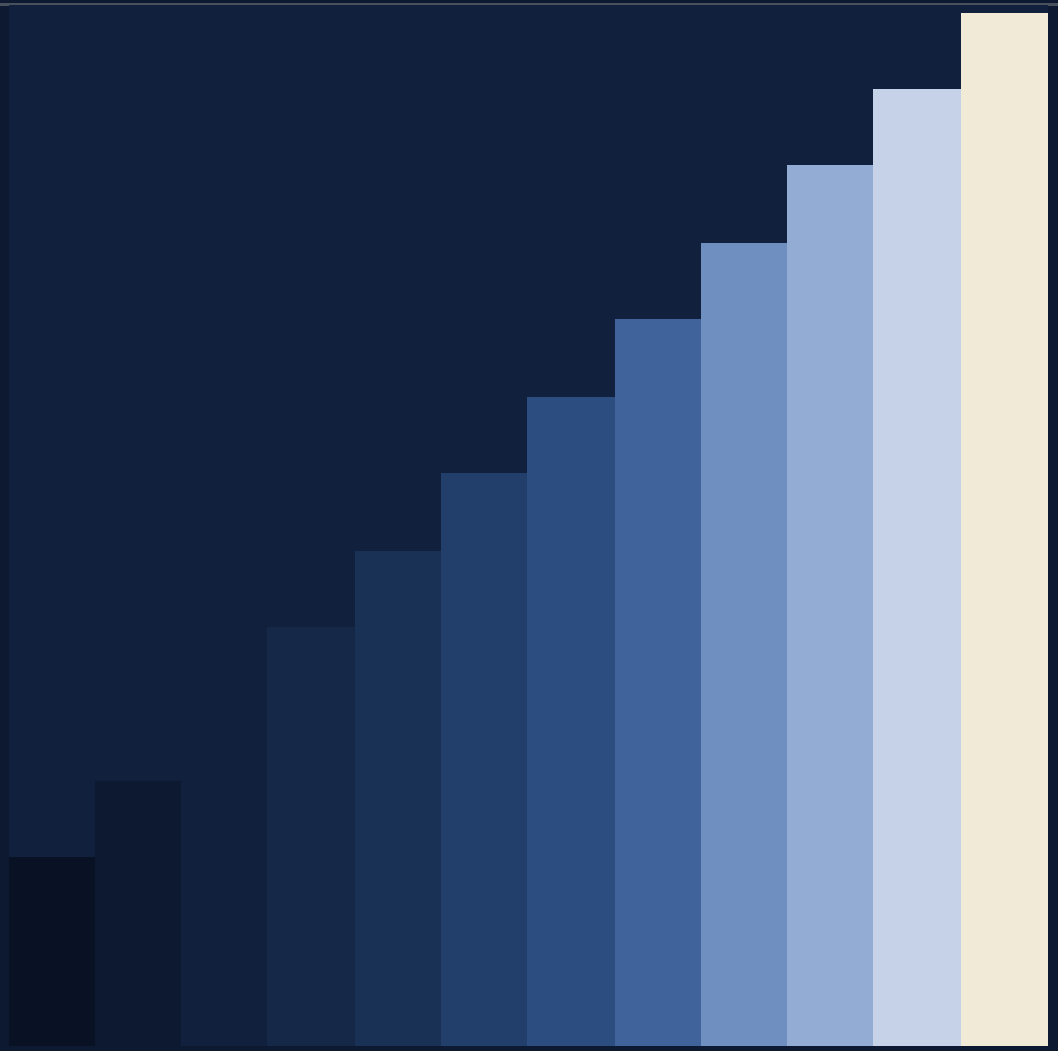
WEIGHT OF AN ACTION



- **Solid cream pill**: the one primary action in view.
- **Outlined pill**: a second action, or the primary repeated in the nav bar.
- **Arrow link**: an action inside a card or a row.
- **Plain link**: navigation.

Colour

02



Night palette

Day palette

Roles

Contrast

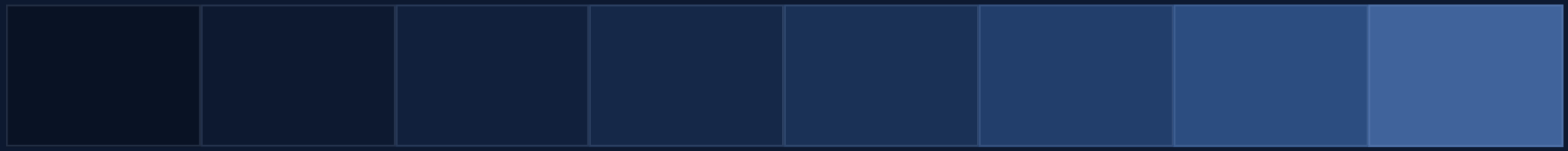
Cream

is the single accent on a navy field. If something is cream, it can be pressed or it is the thing selected.

Night palette.

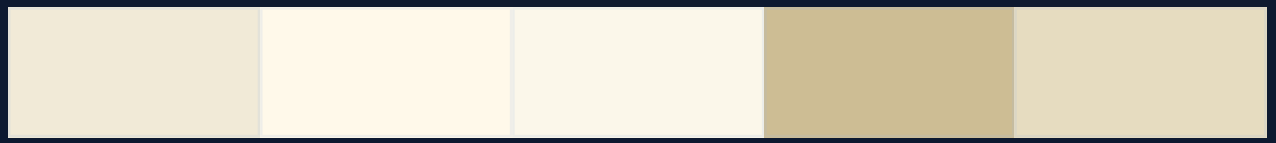
The default theme. A ramp of navy for surfaces, three cool tints for secondary type, and cream as the only accent. Rose and the four practice tints are small, fixed roles, not general-purpose colours.

NAVY RAMP: SURFACES, DARKEST TO LIGHTEST



--ink	--n950	--n900	--n850	--n800	--n700	--n600	--n500
#091224	#0d1930	#11203c	#152848	#1a3156	#223e6b	#2c4d80	#40639b
page edge, footer	body ground; ink on cream surfaces	raised band, menus, navy button	card	card, one step lifted	hover of the navy button, focus on cream	inquiry band, brightest card	reserved

CREAM: THE ACCENT



--cream	--cream-hi	--field	--sand	--cream-2
#f1ead7	#fff9ea	#fbf7ea	#cdbd94	#e6dcc0
primary action, selected state, cream cards	hover of the cream button	text field on a cream card	brass: figure units, warm geometry	reserved

COOL TINTS



--steel-2	--mist	--steel
#93acd4	#c5d2e8	#6f8fc1

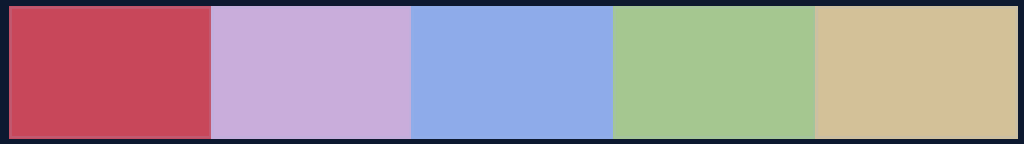
Meta lines, column heads and tags. `--steel` is reserved.

TYPE AND RULES, AS STRENGTHS OF ONE PALE BLUE



--text	--lit	--muted	--faint	--line
#f3efe3	226 233 246 / 90%	214 224 242 / 68%	214 224 242 / 60%	160 186 228 / 16%

UNDERLINE, AND ONE TINT PER PRACTICE AREA



--rose	--lilac	--peri	--sage	--ochre
#c8475a	#c9addb	#8eabea	#a5c790	#d3c198

Day palette.

The same world in daylight: cream paper in place of navy, deep blue as ink and action. Deep blue owns two regions outright, the featured rate and the inquiry band, so the page keeps one strong colour moment instead of scattering it.

PAPER: GROUNDS, LIGHTEST TO DEEPEST

--c-raise	--c-tint	--c-bg	--c-deep	--c-sand
#fbf6ec	#f7f0e2	#f4ecdc	#ece1cb	#e4d5b6
cards, bands, menus	a card one step off the raise	body ground	page edge, footer, alternate band	reserved

DEEP BLUE: INK, ACTION, OWNED REGIONS

--c-blue-ink	--c-blue	--c-blue-2
#152a47	#213a5f	#2d4a72

Buttons, the selected state, links, the featured rate card and the inquiry band.

TYPE AND RULES, AS STRENGTHS OF ONE NAVY INK

--text	--lit	--muted	--faint	--line
#16264b	22 38 75 / 86%	22 38 75 / 72%	22 38 75 / 68%	22 38 75 / 13%

ACCENTS, DEEPENED TO HOLD ON CREAM

--rose	--lilac	--peri	--sage	--ochre
#b5394d	#8a66a6	#587296	#5b8748	#a6833f

PRACTICE CARDS: FOUR CREAMS, STEPPING WARMER

--pcard-1	--pcard-2	--pcard-3	--pcard-4
#fbf6ec	#f8f1e3	#f5ecda	#f1e6d1

- Night values that the day theme does not list are unchanged: the navy ramp and the cream family are the same in both.
- Cream surfaces (the form, the cream button) keep navy ink in both themes. They do not invert.
- Inside the two deep blue regions, type and rules take their night values back.

Roles and contrast.

A colour is chosen by its job, not its look. The table gives each job its night and day value. The contrast figures are calculated from the token file each time this book is printed.

ROLE	NIGHT	DAY
Page ground	`--n950`	`--c-bg`
Raised band (figures)	`--n900`	`--c-raise`
Alternate band (formats)	`--n900`	`--c-deep`
Card	`--n850`	`--c-raise`
Page edge and footer	`--ink`	`--c-deep`
Body type	`--text`	`--text`
Supporting type	`--muted`	`--muted`
Hairline	`--line`	`--line`
Primary action	`--cream` with navy label	`--c-blue` with cream label
Selected state	`--cream`	`--c-blue`
Headline underline	`--rose`	`--rose`
Featured card (hourly rate)	`--cream`	`--c-blue-2` to `--c-blue`
Inquiry band	`--n600` to `--n800`	`--c-blue-2` to `#182f50`
Form card on that band	`--cream`	the same cream
Focus ring	`--cream`	`--c-blue`

PAIR	RATIO	
Type on navy (night)	15.2 : 1	AA
Clear copy on navy (night)	11.8 : 1	AA
Supporting copy on navy (night)	6.7 : 1	AA
Faint copy on navy (night)	5.5 : 1	AA
Supporting copy on a card (night)	5.9 : 1	AA
Meta on a card (night)	6.4 : 1	AA
Navy label on the cream button (night)	14.6 : 1	AA
Meta on a cream card (night)	6.7 : 1	AA
Type on cream paper (day)	12.7 : 1	AA
Supporting copy on cream paper (day)	5.6 : 1	AA
Faint copy on cream paper (day)	4.9 : 1	AA
Label on the deep blue button (day)	10.6 : 1	AA
Meta on a day card (day)	5.8 : 1	AA

- **Rose is a line**, never type and never a button.
- A practice tint marks only its own practice area: its icon, its card gradient, its geometry.
- A new colour goes into the token file with its day value in the same change.

03

Type

Families
Scale
Patterns
Arabic



3 families

Newsreader speaks. Fira Sans does the work. Cairo takes both roles in Arabic.

Families.

A serif for the voice of the firm and a sans for everything functional. In the dry run all three load from Google Fonts. They are to be hosted with the site before launch.

Aa

Newsreader

Headings, figures, prices, the reading passage, the sign-off.

400 — Clear answers on Syria's economy.

400 ITALIC — *Syria's economy.*

500 — Research and studies

Weights in use: 400 for almost everything, 500 for small card headings, italic 400 for the emphasised words of a heading. Lining numerals. Optical sizing on.

`--serif: Newsreader,Iowan Old Style,Times New Roman,serif`

Aa

Fira Sans

Body copy, buttons, labels, navigation, meta, forms.

400 — We pair rigorous data analysis with deep local context.

500 — **Start an inquiry**

600 — **Your email**

Weights in use: 400 for copy, 500 for anything pressable and for meta, 600 for form labels and footer headings. Tabular numerals in data readouts.

`--sans: Fira Sans,system-ui,-apple-system,Segoe UI,sans-serif`

أب

Cairo

Everything in Arabic, headings and body alike.

400 — نجمع بين التحليل الدقيق للبيانات والمعرفة العميقة بالسياق المحلي والوصول الميداني داخل البلاد وخارجها.

500 — ابدأ استفسارًا

600 — إجابات واضحة عن اقتصاد سوريا.

Weights in use: 400 for copy, 500 for the reading passage and column heads, 600 for headings, figures and emphasis.

`--arabic: Cairo,system-ui,-apple-system,Segoe UI,sans-serif`

Scale.

Display sizes are fluid: each grows with the width of the screen between a smallest and a largest size, given here in pixels. Body sizes are fixed. One rem is 16 px.

ROLE	TOKEN	FACE	SIZE	LINE	TRACKING
Page title	`--fs-h1`	Serif 400	43.2 to 80 px	1.06	-0.022em
Hero headline	`--fs-hero`	Serif 400	41.6 to 64 px	1.06	-0.022em
Section heading	`--fs-h2`	Serif 400	33.6 to 56 px	1.1	-0.018em
Practice card heading	`--fs-card-title`	Serif 400	29.6 to 44 px	1.08	-0.018em
Card heading	`--fs-h3`	Serif 500	25.6 px	1.16	-0.01em
Reading passage	`--fs-statement`	Serif 400	24.8 to 40 px	1.24	-0.012em
Sign-off line	`--fs-signoff`	Serif 400	32 to 87.2 px	1.08	-0.025em
Figure	`--fs-figure`	Serif 400	32 to 44.8 px	1	-0.03em
Price	`--fs-price`	Serif 400	64 to 96 px	0.86	-0.04em
Lede	`--fs-lede`	Sans 400	17.9 px	1.6	0
Paragraph under a heading	`--fs-sub`	Sans 400	17.6 px	1.6	0
Body	`--fs-body`	Sans 400	17 px	1.6	0
Body on phones	`--fs-body-sm`	Sans 400	16 px	1.6	0

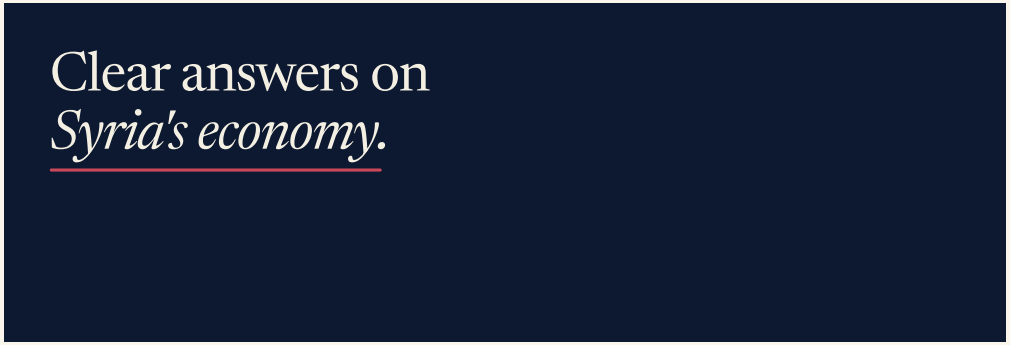
SMALL TEXT, AS BUILT

PX	USED FOR
15.2	Toggle buttons, the note on the rate card
14.9	Nav links, footer links
14.4	Form labels, units beside a price
14.1	Chips, client names, error lines
13.8	Card meta, help text, legal line, footer heads
13.4	Tags, client column heads
13.1	Figure labels, language button
12.8	Map readout
12.5	Label above the hero field
12.2	Small toggle
11.5	Figure inside a map callout

Eleven sizes within four pixels. They are set in the page's stylesheet, not in the token file, and are a candidate for reduction to four steps before the system is final.

Patterns, and Arabic.

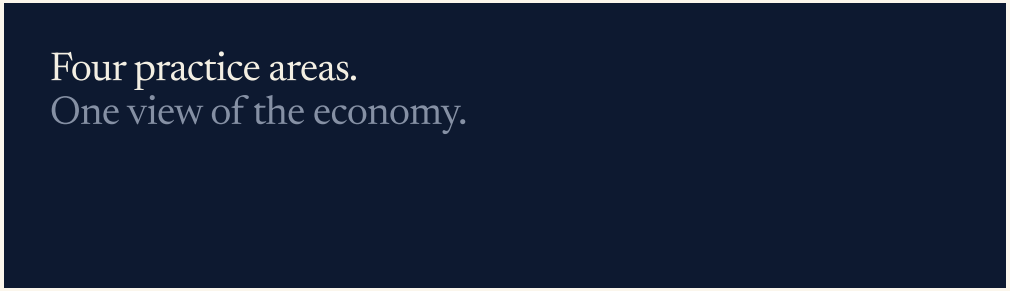
How headings are written matters as much as their size. The same patterns hold in Arabic, with emphasis carried by weight and colour because the script has no italic.



HEADLINE: KEY WORDS IN ITALIC, UNDERLINED ONCE IN ROSE — NIGHT



HEADLINE IN ARABIC: WEIGHT 600, NO ITALIC — NIGHT, ARABIC



SECTION HEADING: A STATEMENT, THEN A DIMMED SECOND SENTENCE — NIGHT



SECTION HEADING IN ARABIC — NIGHT, ARABIC

- Headings are sentences. They end with a full stop.
- Italic is Newsreader 400 only, for the words that carry the point. The rose underline appears once on a page.
- Headings wrap balanced, paragraphs wrap without orphans. Paragraphs hold to 26 to 34 em.
- Cairo for everything. Tracking is zero everywhere, because the letters join.
- Headings at weight 600 and line height 1.3 to 1.35. Body at line height 1.85. Emphasis is weight 600, in cream inside section headings.
- Digits stay Western. Email fields stay left to right. The logo keeps its Latin wordmark.

Layout

04

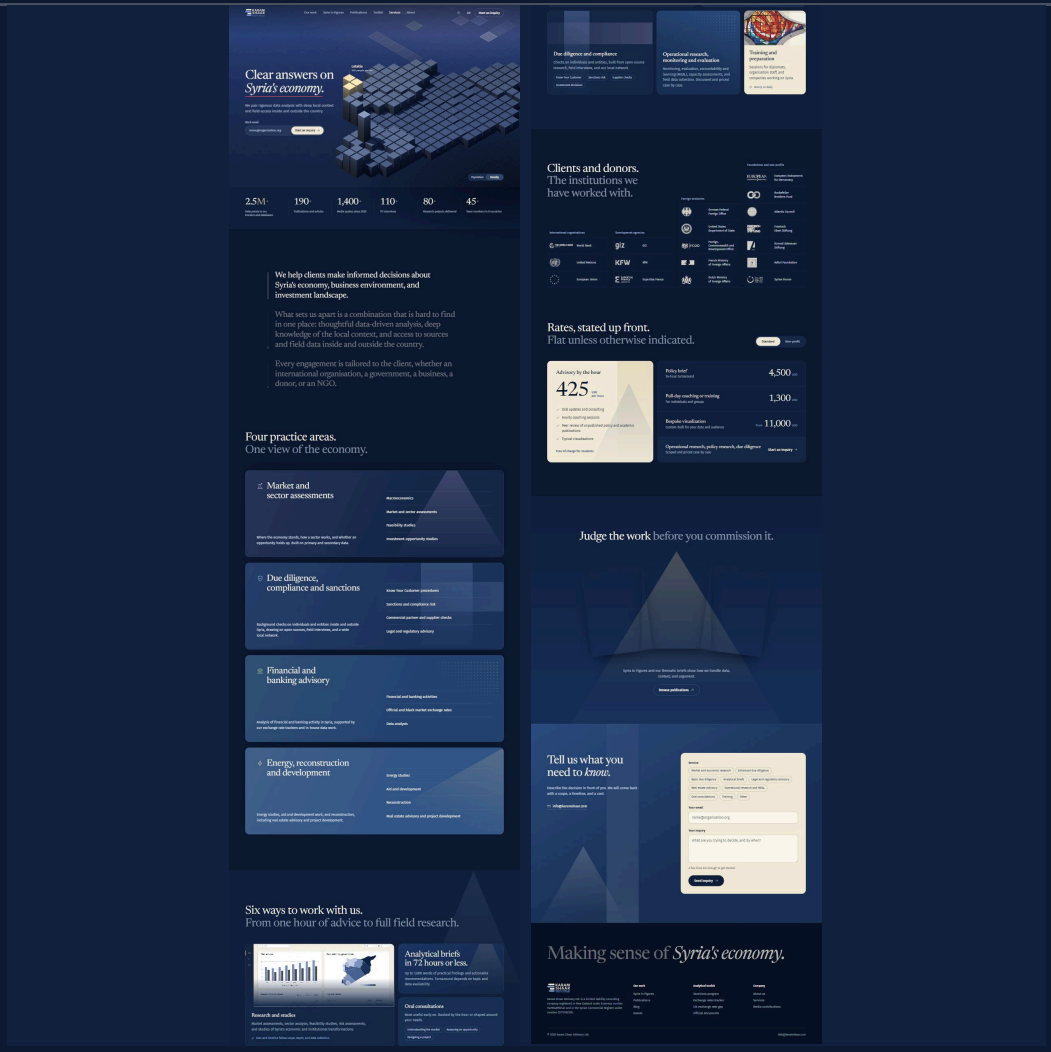
Container

Rhythm

Grids

Breakpoints

The page, band by band



1280 px

is the widest the content column gets. Bands run from edge to edge of the screen. What they hold stays on one column.

Space and grids.

Space is fluid like the type: section spacing grows with the screen between a smallest and a largest value. Inside a band, everything aligns to one column and a small set of grids.

CONTENT COLUMN
1280 px
--wrap

SIDE MARGIN
24 px
16 px on phones

BETWEEN CARDS
20 px
--gap

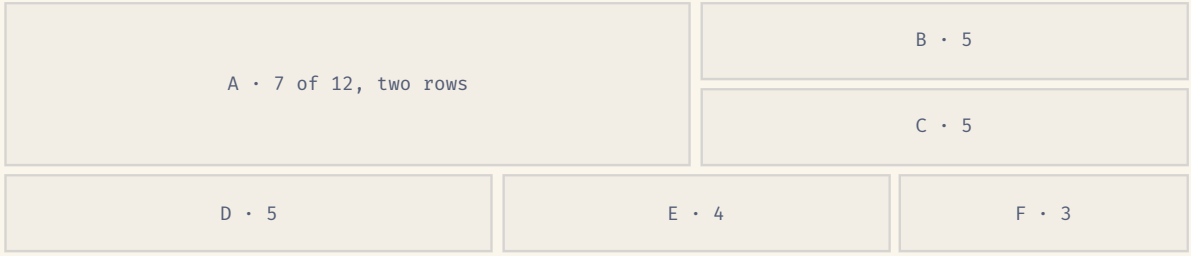
ABOVE AND BELOW A SECTION
100 to 170 px
--sec-y

UNDER A SECTION HEADING
40 to 68 px
--sec-head

AROUND THE READING PASSAGE
110 to 210 px
the page's one long pause

INSIDE A CARD	PADDING
Practice card	28 to 56 px
Format card	30 px, 12 px between lines
Featured rate	28 to 44 px
Rate row	28 px by 22 to 40 px
Form card	22 to 38 px, 24 px between fields

FORMATS: TWELVE COLUMNS, SIX CARDS

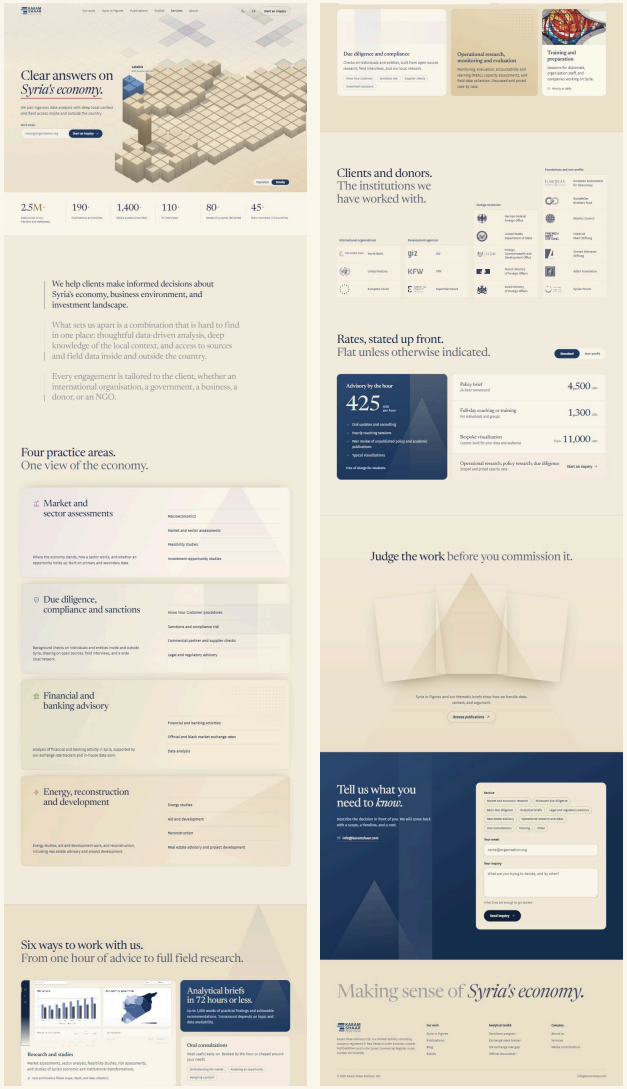


GRID	DESKTOP	TABLET	PHONE
Figures	6 across	3 across	2 across
Practice card	1 : 0.92	1 : 0.92	1 column
Formats	12 columns	A full, then 6 + 6, 7 + 5	1 column
Rates	5 : 7	1 column	1 column
Inquiry	1 : 1.05	1 column	1 column
Clients	4 columns	2 columns (from 1179)	1 column
Footer	1.5 : 1 : 1 : 1	3 columns	2 columns

BREAKPOINT	WIDTH	WHAT CHANGES
Desktop	1101 px and up	Full nav. Hero copy sits beside the map.
Tablet	768 to 1100 px	Menu button. Hero stacks, map below the copy.
Phone	767 px and below	Body 16 px, margins 16 px, cards stop stacking, touch targets 44 px.

The page, band by band.

A page is a stack of full-width bands. Neighbouring bands never share a ground, and a hairline marks each change. Other pages reuse these bands in any order that keeps that alternation.



THE PAGE BY DAY, TOP TO BOTTOM, LEFT TO RIGHT

	BAND	NIGHT GROUND	DAY GROUND	WHAT IT HOLDS
01	Hero	Sky: `#36487f` to `--n900`	Warm wash: `#f8f1e3` to `#f1e6d1`	Headline, one line, an email field. The block map fills the band.
02	Figures	`--n900`	`--c-raise`	The firm in six numbers.
03	Statement	`--n950`	`--c-bg`	Three paragraphs, lit one at a time as they are read.
04	Practice areas	`--n950`, cards `--pcard-1` to `-4`	`--c-bg`, cards stepping warmer	Four cards that stack as the page scrolls.
05	Formats	`--n900`	`--c-deep`	Six ways to work with the firm, as a grid of unequal cards.
06	Clients	`--n950`	`--c-bg`	Every client and donor, in four columns by kind of institution.
07	Rates	`--n950`	`--c-bg`	One featured rate and a list, with a standard and non-profit switch.
08	Proof	`--n900` to `#17305a`	`--c-bg` to `--c-deep`	Three publication covers.
09	Inquiry	`--n600` to `--n800`	`--c-blue-2` to `#182f50`	The form, on a cream card.
10	Footer	`--ink`	`--c-deep`	Sign-off line, links, registration details.

- The hero is one screen tall on desktop. Every other band is as tall as its content plus the section space.
- The nav has no bar of its own: it floats on a soft veil that appears once the page scrolls.

Shape

05

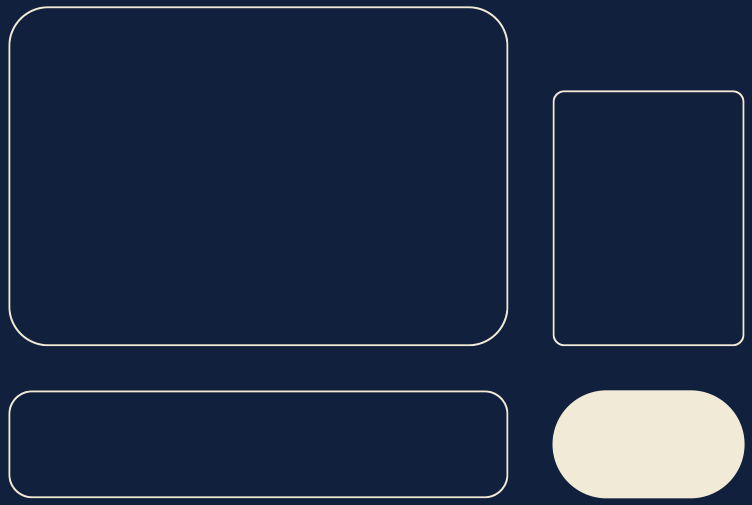
Radius

Line

Depth

Texture

Geometry



4 radii

Cards 20, inputs 12, covers 6, and a full pill for anything that can be pressed. Nothing else.

Edges and depth.

Shape says what a thing is. A full pill can be pressed. A 20 px corner is a surface that holds content. A 6 px corner is a printed object. Depth comes from lightness, and shadow is rare.

RADIUS

TOKEN	PX	USED FOR
`--r-card`	20	Cards, panels, menus
`--r-in`	12	Text fields, menu rows
`--r-btn`	full	Buttons, chips, toggles, nav links
`--r-tag`	full	Small labels that cannot be pressed
`--r-cover`	6	Publication covers

Two as-built exceptions: the hero email field takes 22 px when it stacks on phones, and the focus ring is 6 px.

LINE

- One hairline, 1 px in `--line`: between bands, around cards, between rows.
- Pills are outlined with a 1 px ring drawn inside the shape, at about 30% of their ink, rising to 55 to 75% on hover.
- The reading rail beside the statement is the only 2 px line.

DEPTH

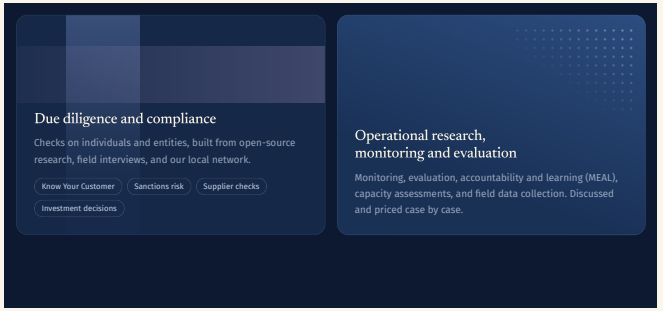
WHERE	SHADOW
Practice cards, as they stack	0 -22 48 -30, near-black navy at 85%
Phone menu	0 24 48 -24, at 70%
Publication covers	0 34 70 -28, at 90%, plus a 1 px light ring

Three shadows carry the page's depth, each where one object lies over another. Cards do not float. By day the same shadows turn warm brown at 28 to 45%.

TEXTURE

A fine film grain lies over the whole page in two fixed layers, at 7% and 3.5% strength (5% and 3% by day). It is switched off in print and is under review: see the last chapter.

GEOMETRY



- Three motifs from the firm's brochure: a tall triangle, an upright band, a field of dots at a 15 to 16 px pitch.
- Each is a light tint that fades to nothing. On a practice card it takes that area's tint.
- Geometry is decoration only. It mirrors in Arabic and thins out on phones.

Components

06

Actions

- Inputs
- Navigation
- Cards
- Rates and figures
- Proof and clients

Six ways to work with us.
From one hour of advice to full field research.



Research and studies

Market assessments, sector analysis, feasibility studies, risk assessments, and studies of Syria's economic and institutional transformations.

Cost and timeline follow scope, depth, and data collection

Analytical briefs in 72 hours or less.

Up to 1,000 words of practical findings and actionable recommendations. Turnaround depends on topic and data availability.

Oral consultations

Most useful early on. Booked by the hour or shaped around your needs.

Understanding the market · Assessing an opportunity · Designing a project

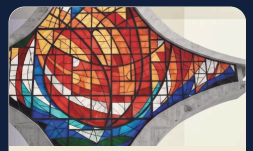
Due diligence and compliance

Checks on individuals and entities, built from open-source research, field interviews, and our local network.

Know Your Customer · Sanctions risk · Supplier checks · Investment decisions

Operational research, monitoring and evaluation

Monitoring, evaluation, accountability and learning (MEAL), capacity assessments, and field data collection. Discussed and priced case by case.



Training and preparation

Sessions for diplomats, organisation staff, and companies working on Syria.

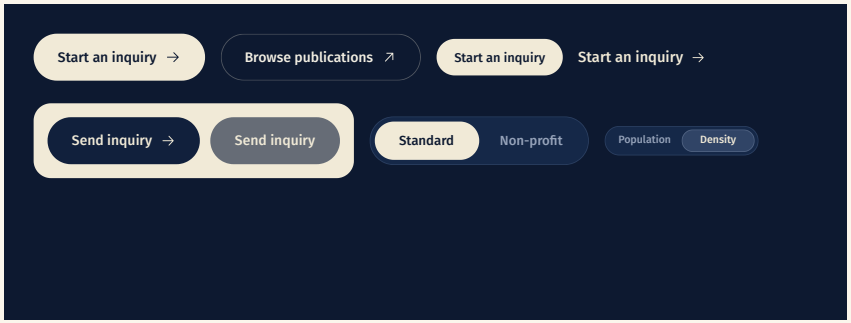
Hourly or daily

Live specimens

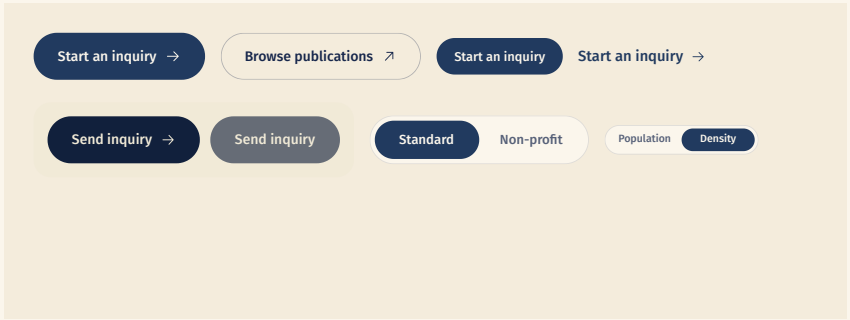
Each component on the next pages is drawn by the page's own stylesheet, in both lights. What is printed here is what the site does.

Actions.

Everything that can be pressed is a pill. One solid cream button per view. The navy button exists only on cream surfaces. The nav bar repeats the primary action as an outline so the hero's button stays the only solid one.



BUTTONS, ARROW LINK, TOGGLES NIGHT



BUTTONS, ARROW LINK, TOGGLES DAY

PART	SIZE	TYPE	STATES
Button	54 px high, 28 px sides, pill	17 px, 500	Hover: lighter fill, arrow moves 4 px. Press: 98% scale. Disabled: 62%.
Small button	42 px high, 20 px sides	14.7 px, 500	As above.
Cream (primary)	`--cream` fill, navy label		Hover `--cream-hi`. By day: `--c-blue` fill, cream label.
Outlined (ghost)	1 px inner ring at 30%		Hover: ring 75%, 6% fill.
Navy, on cream only	`--n900` fill, cream label		Hover `--n700`.
Arrow link	Text and a 1 em arrow, 0.5 em apart	17 px, 500	Hover: arrow moves 4 px. Cream by night, deep blue by day.
Toggle	Track with 5 px inset, buttons 44 px high	15.2 px, 500	Cream thumb slides in 0.7 s. Chosen label turns navy.
Small toggle	3 px inset, buttons 26 px high	12.2 px, 500	Translucent thumb, chosen label cream. Used on the map.

- Icons are 1.1 em, 0.6 em from the label, and always follow it.
- Arrows point with the reading direction and mirror in Arabic.
- Focus: a 2 px ring, 3 px clear of the shape, cream by night and deep blue by day.

Inputs.

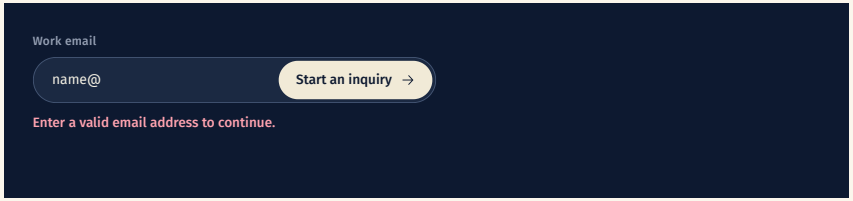
Two input styles. On the navy field, one pill holds the email field and its button together. On the cream form card, fields are plain rectangles with 12 px corners and a visible label above each.



HERO EMAIL FIELD NIGHT

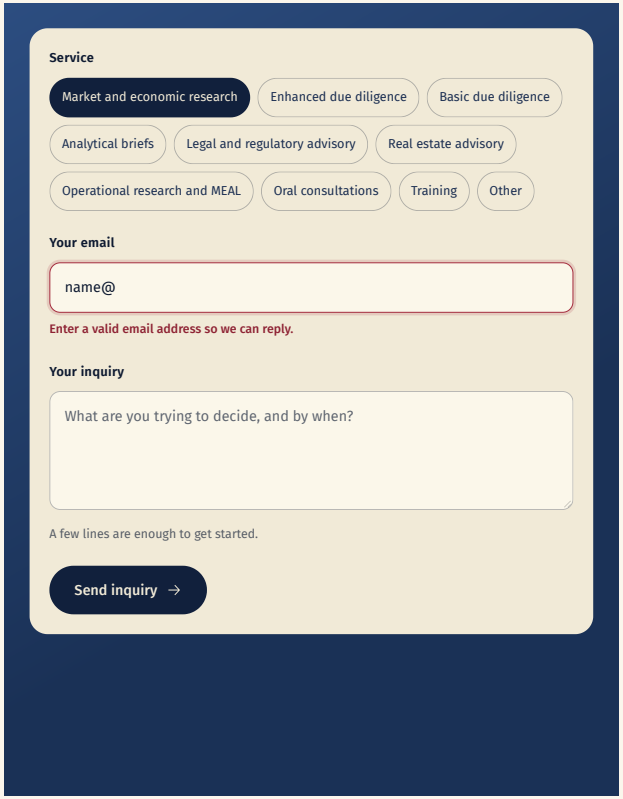


HERO EMAIL FIELD DAY



WITH ITS ERROR LINE NIGHT

- A label is always visible above its field. Placeholders show a format, never the label.
- Errors appear under the field in a sentence that says what to do.

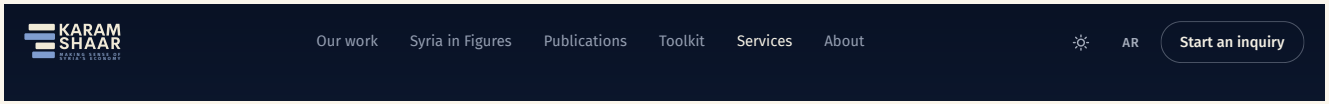


FORM CARD: CHOSEN CHIP, FIELD IN ERROR NIGHT

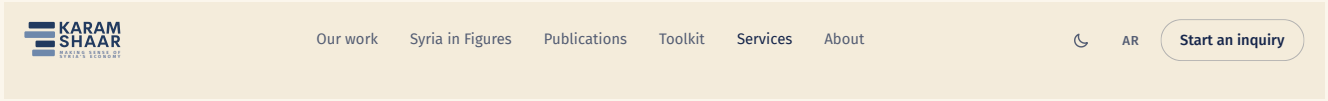
PART	MEASURE
Hero field	Pill, 4 px inset, field and button 40 px high, at most 392 px wide. Ring turns cream on focus.
Text field	14 by 16 px padding, 1 px navy line at 30%, `--r-in`, ground `--field`.
Label	14.4 px, 600, 10 px above the field.
Focus	Line turns `--n700`, plus a 3 px soft ring.
Error	Line turns `--err`, soft red ring, message in `--err-ink` at 13.8 px, 500.
Chip (one choice)	9 by 14 px, pill, 14.1 px. Chosen: `--n900` fill, cream label. 44 px high on phones.
Tag (not pressable)	7 by 13 px, pill, 13.4 px, 1 px ring at 26%.

Navigation and footer.

The nav bar has no box. It is type laid over the page, on a veil of blur and tint that appears once the page scrolls. The footer is the darkest surface on the page and ends on the firm's line.



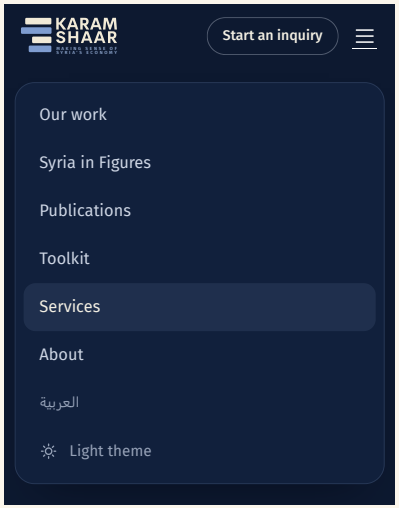
NAV BAR — NIGHT



NAV BAR — DAY



FOOTER — NIGHT



PHONE MENU — NIGHT

PART	MEASURE
Bar	76 px high (64 on tablet and phone), on the content column.
Veil	14 px blur and a tint that fade out over 130 to 150 px.
Logo	97 by 38 px in the bar, 113 by 44 px in the footer.
Links	14.9 px, 9 by 14 px, pill highlight on hover. Current page at full strength.
Round buttons	Theme and language, 42 px. Menu, 44 px.
Phone menu	One panel, `--r-card`, rows 48 px high.
Footer	Ground `--ink`. Columns 1.5 : 1 : 1 : 1, 36 px apart. Links 14.9 px.

Cards.

A card is one surface with one idea. Cards are never placed inside cards. The practice cards stack as the page scrolls. The format cards sit in a grid of unequal sizes so that the eye has an order to follow.



PRACTICE CARD NIGHT



PRACTICE CARD DAY

PRACTICE CARD

Surface	`--r-card`, 28 to 56 px padding, two columns 1 : 0.92.
Ground	Its area tint mixed 11% into its navy, fading to plain navy by 62%.
Title	`--fs-card-title` with a 34 px line icon in the area tint.
List	Rows with 19 px above and below, a hairline between, 17.6 px type.
Stack	Each card pins 18 px lower than the one before. Not on phones.



FORMAT CARDS NIGHT

FORMAT CARD

Surface	`--r-card`, ground `--n850`, hairline that brightens on hover.
Body	30 px padding, 12 px between lines, set at the foot of the card.
Title	`--fs-h3`, 500. One card states its point as a large title instead.
Meta	13.8 px with a 1 em icon, in `--steel-2`.
Picture	At least 300 px high, fades into the card, grows 4% on hover.

Rates and figures.

Numbers are set in the serif at display size, with their unit small beside them in the sans. The one featured rate takes the accent surface: cream by night, deep blue by day.



RATES NIGHT



RATES DAY



FIGURES ROW NIGHT

PART	MEASURE
Figure	`--fs-figure`, serif 400. Plus sign and unit in `--sand` (brass by day).
Figure label	13.1 px, supporting ink, at most 15 em wide.
Figures row	Six across with a hairline between. Three on tablet, two on phone.
Featured rate	`--r-card`, 28 to 44 px padding. Price at `--fs-price`, line height 0.86.
Unit beside a price	14.4 px, 500, tracking 0.05 em, in `--ink-blue`.
Rate row	28 px by 22 to 40 px. Title 23.2 px serif, figure 32 to 44.8 px serif.
Row hover	A 6% wash, and the row moves 6 px toward its start.
Switch	Standard or non-profit. The changed figures rise 0.28 em into place.

- Rates are flat and stated in full. A price that depends on scope says so and offers the inquiry link instead of a number.

Proof and clients.

The firm's publications and clients are shown as themselves: real covers, real names. Client marks are drawn in one ink so that eighteen different logos read as one wall.



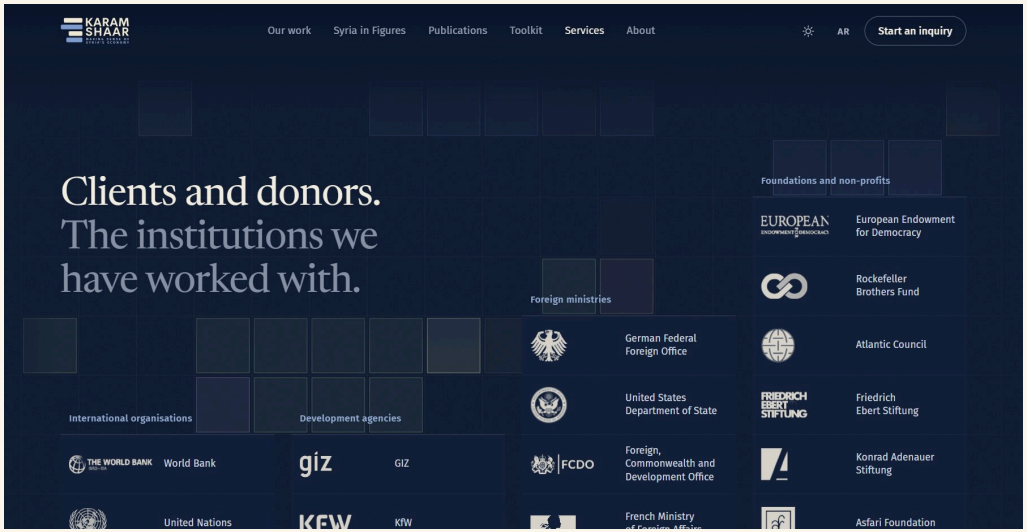
PUBLICATION COVERS NIGHT

We help clients make informed decisions about Syria's economy, business environment, and investment landscape.

What sets us apart is a combination that is hard to find in one place: thoughtful data-driven analysis, deep knowledge of the local context, and access to sources and field data inside and outside the country.

Every engagement is tailored to the client, whether an international organisation, a government, a business, a donor, or an NGO.

READING PASSAGE NIGHT



CLIENTS WALL, AS ON THE PAGE

PART	MEASURE
Cover	`--r-cover`, 150 to 300 px wide (centre 170 to 340). Side covers lean 7 degrees, 3 on hover.
Reading passage	`--fs-statement`, line height 1.24. Unread paragraphs at 42%. A 2 px rail fills beside the one being read.
Client cell	At least 84 px high (64 on phones), 8 by 12 px padding, a 118 px slot for the mark, name at 14.1 px.
Client column	Head at 13.4 px, 500. Columns stand on one baseline, each as tall as its count.
Cell hover	The cell turns to cream paper and the mark shows in its real colours.

07

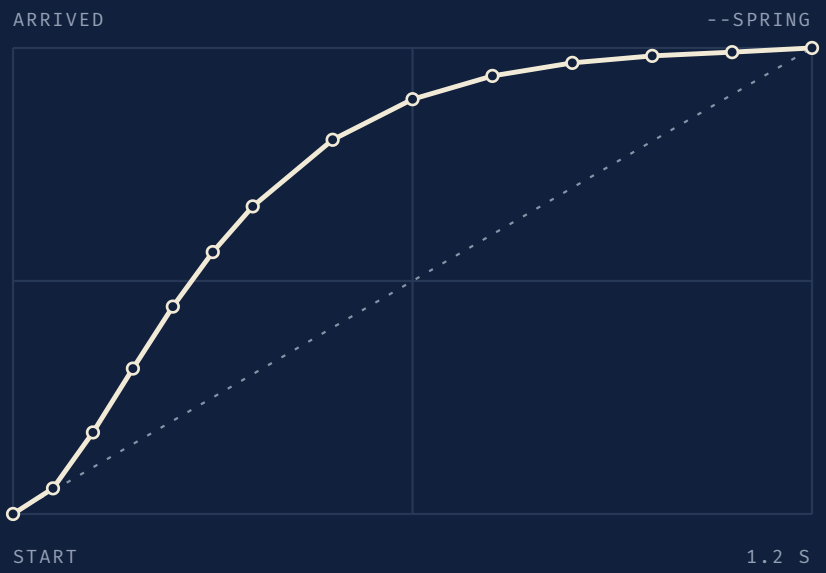
Motion

One curve

Durations

The catalogue

Reduced motion



1.2 s

for content to rise into place, on a spring with no bounce. It arrives once and then stays still.

The catalogue.

Every movement on the page, with what starts it and how long it takes. Most use the one spring. Colour changes use the plain ease. Nothing moves unless the visitor scrolls, points or presses.

MOVEMENT	STARTS WHEN	WHAT HAPPENS	TIME	CURVE
Arrival	A block is 10% in view	Rises 48 px (24 to 72 by block) and fades in. Siblings follow 0.1 s apart.	1.2 s	Spring
Nav bar	The page opens	Drops 36 px and fades in.	1 s	Ease in and out
Headline underline	With the headline	The rose line draws from the start of the words.	1.1 s, after 0.75 s	Spring
Figure reels	The row is in view	Each digit rolls to its value. The plus signs land last.	2 s	Spring
Reading passage	Scrolling	The paragraph being read lights. Its rail fills.	0.9 s	Ease
Practice stack	Scrolling	Cards pin and stack, each 18 px lower.	With the scroll	
Toggle	A press	The thumb slides. Changed figures rise 0.28 em.	0.7 s	Spring
Card picture	Pointer over a card	The picture grows to 104%.	1.4 s	Ease
Covers	Pointer over the fan	Side covers close from 7 to 3 degrees. The centre lifts 3%.	0.9 s	Spring
Client cell	Pointer over a cell	Turns to cream paper. The mark takes its real colours.	0.35 s	Ease
Buttons and links	Pointer or press	Colour changes. The arrow moves 4 px. A press shrinks to 98%.	0.2 s to 0.25 s	Ease
Map callout	A governorate is lit	A hairline grows from the block. The label rises 10 px.	0.6 to 0.7 s	Spring
Theme switch	The theme button	The whole page cross-fades.	0.45 s	Ease
Smooth scroll	Wheel or trackpad	The page eases to rest (Lenis).	1.15 s	Exponential out

RULES

- One spring, one ease. `--spring` and `--ease` are the only curves.
- Things arrive once. Leaving is not animated.
- Only position, scale and opacity move. Layout never animates.
- Ambient drawing (the lattice, the idle map) stops when it is off screen.

WITH REDUCED MOTION

- Arrivals become a 0.4 s fade with no movement.
- The underline, the rail and the figures appear complete.
- Smooth scroll, the theme cross-fade and hover movement are off.
- The lattice and the map hold still, already lit.

08

Assets

Logo
Icons
Pictures
The block map

KARAM SHAAR
MAKING SENSE OF SYRIA'S ECONOMY

Data is the picture

The map, the figures and the firm's own covers are the imagery. No stock photographs, no decorative illustration.

Logo and icons.

The mark is the firm's existing logo, four bars and a wordmark, redrawn as one vector and recoloured for each ground. Icons are few, drawn as lines, and always take the colour of the text beside them.



ON THE PAGE GROUND NIGHT

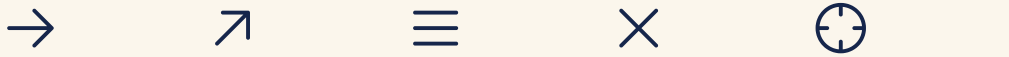


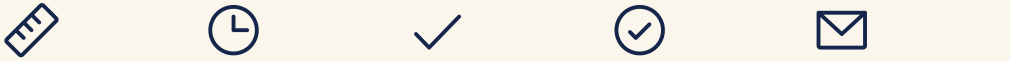
ON THE PAGE GROUND DAY

PART OF THE MARK	NIGHT	DAY
Bars 1 and 4	--logo-bar	--logo-bar
Bars 2 and 3, wordmark	--logo-ink	--logo-ink
Tagline	--logo-tag	--logo-tag

- Proportion 1430 : 558. In use at 97 by 38 px (nav) and 113 by 44 px (footer).
- The tagline inside the mark is Fira Sans 500. The Arabic page keeps the Latin wordmark.
- On hover the four bars ripple once, then rest.
- The original mark on karamshaar.com is charcoal #545454 and steel blue #738aa7 (measured October 2026). It is recoloured here, not redrawn.

INTERFACE ICONS: PHOSPHOR, REGULAR WEIGHT





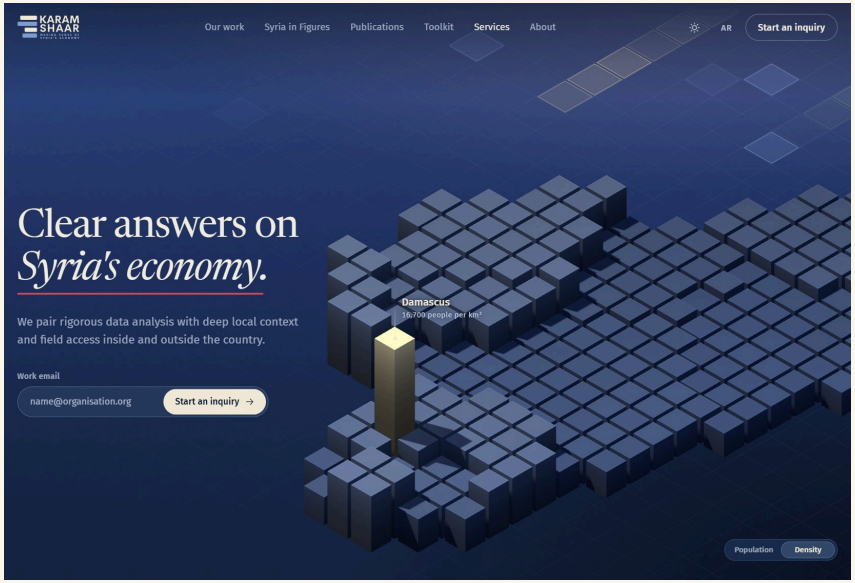
PRACTICE AREAS: DRAWN FOR THIS PAGE

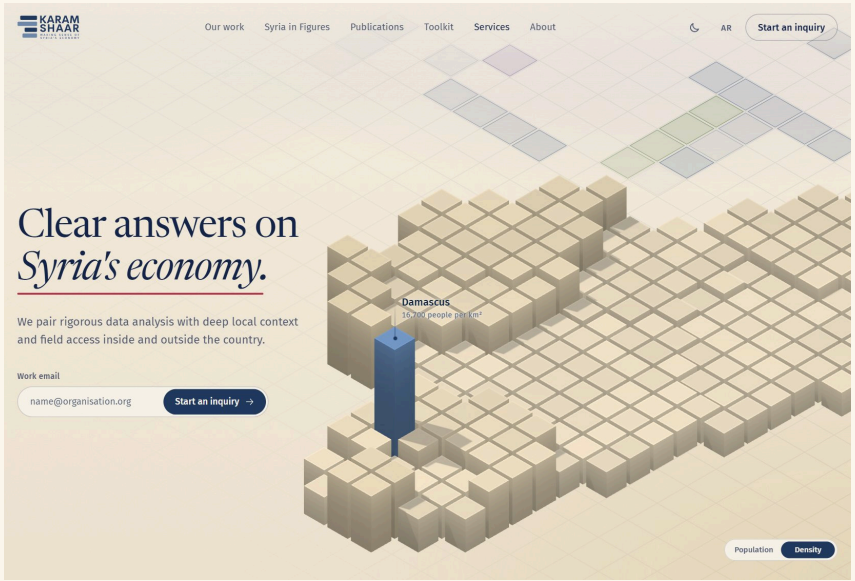


- Interface icons are ten drawings from Phosphor Icons 2.1.1 (MIT licence), 1 em square, filled with the text colour.
- Practice icons are line drawings on a 24 unit grid with a 1.5 stroke and round ends, shown at 34 px in their area's tint.
- A new interface icon is added to the page's stylesheet as one more .ph-name rule.

Pictures and the block map.

The hero is a model of Syria built from columns, where height carries a figure for each governorate. It is the firm's work in one image: a country made legible as data.





VIEW

Isometric

A true isometric camera at 35.264 degrees

GRID

30 km columns

A square grid turned 45 degrees, north up

HEIGHT

A figure

Population, or density on a log scale

SOURCE

2011

Central Bureau of Statistics estimate

MAP COLOUR	NIGHT	DAY
Lowest column `--map-lo`	`#2b4a84`	`#f8f2e4`
Highest column `--map-hi`	`#a9c2ec`	`#e3d5b4`
Lit governorate `--map-lit`	`#d8c8a2`	`#5679ab`

- The whole country stays in frame. The map is never cropped and never fades at its edges.
- A callout is bare type on a hairline that ends in a dot on the block: name at 16.3 px, figure at 11.5 px in tabular numerals.
- Without WebGL the same blocks are painted once on a flat canvas.
- **Covers** are the firm's own publications. **Client marks** are drawn in one ink, cream by night and navy by day, and show their real colours only under the pointer.
- The map's stone and coloured lights are tokens, so a change of palette reaches the map too.

09

Languages

Arabic

Mirroring

Focus

Touch

Reduced motion

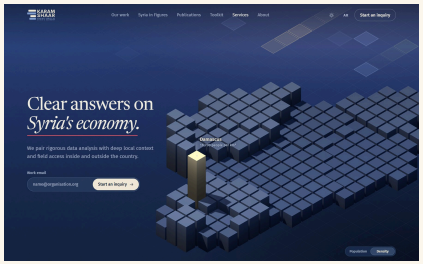


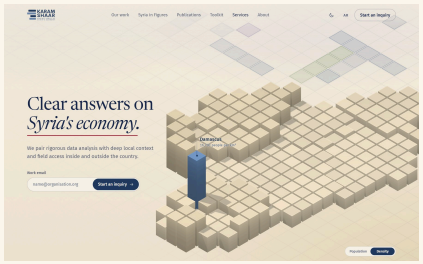
4 states

English and Arabic, night and day. A change is finished when it is right in all four.

Arabic, and access.

Arabic is not the English page reversed. Type, emphasis and line height change with the script, and decoration mirrors so the open sky stays behind the map. Access is part of the same care.









MIRRORS IN ARABIC	STAYS AS IT IS
Layout direction and text alignment	The logo and its Latin wordmark
Arrows, and the way they move on hover	Digits, which stay Western
The sky, its haze and its dark corner	Email fields, typed left to right
Card geometry, the cover fan, the toggle thumb	The map: geography does not flip
The reading rail and the headline underline	Check, clock and ruler icons

ACCESS

- **Focus** is always visible: a 2 px ring, 3 px clear of the shape. Cream on navy, deep blue on cream paper, navy on the cream form.
- **Keyboard**: a skip link comes first. The map takes focus, and the arrow keys step through the governorates while the page announces each one.
- **Touch**: on phones every target is at least 44 px high: chips, footer links, menu rows.
- **Controls say what they are**: toggles report pressed or not, chips form one radio group, an error is tied to its field.
- **Contrast**: body and supporting type meet AA on every ground. The measured ratios are in chapter 02.
- **Motion**: everything has a still form. See chapter 07.
- **Language**: the page declares its language and direction, and each theme declares its colour scheme to the browser.





On phones the hero reorders: headline and line, then the map, then the email field, so the map sits above the button. Night in English, day in Arabic.

10

Platforms

Other pages

Data tools

Reports

Slides

Social

Navy

#0d1930

Cream

#f1ead7

Day paper

#f4ecdc

Deep blue

#213a5f

Type on navy

#f3efe3

Rose, as a line

#c8475a

Carry the core

Navy, cream, two faces, four radii and one curve travel everywhere. The rest belongs to the Services page.

One language, other surfaces.

This chapter is guidance drawn from the Services page. None of these surfaces has been built with the system yet. Treat each row as a starting brief, and record here what proves right when it is built.

SURFACE	LIGHT	CARRY OVER	ADAPT
Other pages of the site	Night or day, as the visitor chooses	Everything. They live beside the Services page and take the same token block and components.	Only the order of bands. Keep the alternation of grounds.
Data tools and trackers	Day for dense tables and long sessions	Fira Sans for all interface and numbers, with tabular numerals. Hairlines instead of boxes. Pills for controls.	Newsreader only for page titles and headline figures. Series colours from the practice tints, steel for neutral series, the accent for the selected series only.
Reports and PDFs	Day: cream or white paper, navy ink	Newsreader headings, Fira Sans text, sentence headings, the rose line once on a cover, 6 px corners on pictures.	Sizes by ratio, not pixels: text 10 to 11 pt, section heading about twice that, title about three times. No grain.
Slides	Night for title and section slides, day for content	Two-part headings, figures in the serif, one cream element per slide as the point of focus.	Nothing smaller than 24 pt. One idea per slide.
Social cards	Night	A serif headline with one italic phrase, the logo in its night colours, one figure or one map.	Never a collage. Never more than one accent.
Email and office documents	Day	The colours as they are.	Where the fonts cannot load, the fallbacks in the token file: Iowan Old Style or Times New Roman, and the system sans.

THE PORTABLE CORE

	HEX	RGB
Navy	#0d1930	13 25 48
Cream	#f1ead7	241 234 215
Type on navy	#f3efe3	243 239 227
Rose	#c8475a	200 71 90
Day paper	#f4ecdc	244 236 220
Day ink	#16264b	22 38 75
Deep blue	#213a5f	33 58 95

NOT DEFINED YET

- ◇ Print values (CMYK, Pantone) and paper stock.
- ◇ A sequential colour ramp for charts and maps beyond the block map.
- ◇ Motion for video.

11

Upkeep

Changing a value

What lives where

Status

Open questions

```
:root{
  /* ---- colour: navy ramp (night theme grounds, darkest to lightest) ---- */
  --ink:#091224;                /* page edge, footer */
  --n950:#0d1930;               /* body ground; ink on cream surfaces */
  --n900:#11203c;               /* raised band, menus, navy button */
  --n850:#152848;               /* card */
  --n800:#1a3156;               /* card, one step lifted */
  --n700:#223e6b;               /* hover of the navy button, focus on cream */
  --n600:#2c4d80;               /* inquiry band, brightest card */
  --n500:#40639b;               /* reserved */
  --n925:#0f1c36;               /* faces of the clients wall, between ground and band */
  --n825:#17305a;               /* foot of the proof band */
  --n750:#1d3764;               /* lit corner of the statement card */

  /* ---- colour: cool tints (secondary text, meta, rules) ---- */
  --steel:#6f8fc1; --steel-2:#93acd4; --mist:#c5d2e8;

  /* ---- colour: pale inks, washes and shade on navy (the same in both themes) ---- */
  --on-dark:#f3efe3;            /* type on navy, also inside the deep regions of the day them
  --ice-1:#e2e9f6; --ice-2:#d6e0f2; --ice-3:#c5d2e8;   /* pale blue inks, strongest to softest
  --tint:#a0bae4;               /* washes under the pointer, hairlines */
  --shade:#040918; --shade-2:#081022;   /* corner vignette; veil under the nav */

  /* ---- colour: cream, the single accent ---- */
  --cream:#f1ead7;              /* primary action, selected state, cream cards */
  --cream-hi:#fff9ea;           /* hover of the cream button */
  --cream-2:#e6dcc0;            /* reserved */
  --sand:#cdbd94;               /* brass: figure units, warm geometry */
  --field:#fbf7ea;              /* text field on a cream card */

  /* ---- colour: brand underline and the four practice areas ---- */
  --rose:#c8475a;               /* only as the underline beneath the headline's key words */
```

One file

Colours, type sizes, radii, spacing and timing are changed in the token file. One command carries them to the page and reprints this book.

How a change is made.

The values this book records are not typed into the page. They are kept in one short file, and a build step copies them into the page and reprints the book, so a small change is small work.

01

Say it plainly

"Make the cream warmer." "Round the cards less." No code is needed to ask. To compare first, it becomes a switch in the testing ground.

02

Change the token

The value is edited once, in `design-system/tokens.css`. A day value is changed with its night value.

03

Run the build

`node design-system/build.mjs` copies the tokens into every page in `site/` and reprints this PDF.

04

Check and publish

Look at the page in its four states, then republish. The page and the book now agree again.

A REQUEST, AND THE TOKEN IT CHANGES

ASKED FOR	TOKEN
A warmer or cooler cream	`--cream`, and by day `--c-bg`, `--c-raise`
A darker or lighter navy	`--n950` to `--n600`
A different heading face	`--serif`, and the font link in the page
Larger section headings	`--fs-h2`
Larger body text	`--fs-body`
Rounder or squarer cards	`--r-card`
More air between sections	`--sec-y`
A slower or faster arrival	`--t-reveal`, `--rise`
A wider or narrower page	`--wrap`
Taller buttons	`--h-btn`

WHAT LIVES WHERE

FILE	HOLDS
`DESIGN.md`	The rules in plain text, and a map of the page's stylesheet. Where a person or an AI assistant starts.
`design-system/tokens.css`	Every shared value. The source of truth.
`design-system/build.mjs`	Copies the tokens into the pages and prints this book.
`design-system/src/`	This book's own pages.
`site/index.html`	The page. Its components are styled in its own stylesheet, in named sections.
`testing-ground/`	Ideas tried as switches on top of the real page, and compared, before any is made real.

Not in the token file yet: the small text sizes, paddings inside components and a few one-off tints. Those are changed in the page's stylesheet, in the section named in `DESIGN.md`.

Status.

What is fixed, what is recorded as built but may still move, and what is undecided. This page is the first to update when a decision is made.

SETTLED

One site, one direction.

- Deep navy, cream as the accent, Newsreader with Fira Sans, the block map in the hero. Settled by the owner on 6 October 2026.
- English and Arabic, night and day, in one page.
- Only real facts about the firm.

DRAFT: RECORDED AS BUILT

May change before the system is final.

- The names and grouping of the tokens.
- The small text scale: eleven sizes within four pixels, to be reduced.
- The day theme's grounds.
- The film grain over the page.
- Chapter 10: guidance for surfaces that have not been built.

OPEN

Undecided, or waiting on something.

- A round of feedback from 9 October 2026 is being tried on a separate test page and is not part of this system until decided: colours nearer the logo's, Georgia or Arial as faces, a near-white day theme, less animation.
- Two of the six figures in the figures row are stand-ins until the real numbers arrive.
- The Arabic copy is a draft awaiting review.
- Fonts and scripts load from public servers in the dry run and are to be hosted with the site before launch.
- The map shows 2011 population. A GDP series is wanted, and no governorate source has been found.

CHANGES

VERSION	DATE	WHAT
0.2	12 October 2026	Sky, map, lattice, pale inks and shade became tokens, with no visual change, so ideas can be tried as switches.
0.1	12 October 2026	First record, taken from the Services page. The page was wired to the token file with no visual change.

Token index: colour.

Every colour in the token file, printed from the file itself. Where the day column says "same", the night value holds in both themes.

TOKEN	NIGHT	DAY	NOTE
--ink	#091224	same	page edge, footer
--n950	#0d1930	same	body ground; ink on cream surfaces
--n900	#11203c	same	raised band, menus, navy button
--n850	#152848	same	card
--n800	#1a3156	same	card, one step lifted
--n700	#223e6b	same	hover of the navy button, focus on cream
--n600	#2c4d80	same	inquiry band, brightest card
--n500	#40639b	same	reserved
--n925	#0f1c36	same	faces of the clients wall, between ground and band
--n825	#17305a	same	foot of the proof band
--n750	#1d3764	same	lit corner of the statement card
--steel	#6f8fc1	same	
--steel-2	#93acd4	#4b6285	
--mist	#c5d2e8	#475c7e	
--on-dark	#f3efe3	same	type on navy, also inside the deep regions of the day theme
--ice-1	#e2e9f6	same	pale blue inks, strongest to softest
--ice-2	#d6e0f2	same	pale blue inks, strongest to softest
--ice-3	#c5d2e8	same	pale blue inks, strongest to softest
--tint	#a0bae4	same	washes under the pointer, hairlines

TOKEN	NIGHT	DAY	NOTE
--shade	#040918	same	corner vignette; veil under the nav
--shade-2	#081022	same	corner vignette; veil under the nav
--cream	#f1ead7	same	primary action, selected state, cream cards
--cream-hi	#fff9ea	same	hover of the cream button
--cream-2	#e6dcc0	same	reserved
--sand	#cdbd94	same	brass: figure units, warm geometry
--field	#fbf7ea	same	text field on a cream card
--rose	#c8475a	#b5394d	only as the underline beneath the headline's key words
--lilac	#c9addb	#8a66a6	
--peri	#8eabea	#587296	
--sage	#a5c790	#5b8748	
--ochre	#d3c198	#a6833f	
--pcard-1	#16294a	#fbf6ec	practice cards, back to front
--pcard-2	#1d355d	#f8f1e3	practice cards, back to front
--pcard-3	#264472	#f5ecda	practice cards, back to front
--pcard-4	#325688	#f1e6d1	practice cards, back to front
--text	#f3efe3	#16264b	
--lit	rgba(226,233,246,.9)	rgba(22,38,75,.86)	body copy that must read clearly
--muted	rgba(214,224,242,.68)	rgba(22,38,75,.72)	supporting copy

Token index: colour, continued.

Every colour in the token file, printed from the file itself. Where the day column says "same", the night value holds in both themes.

TOKEN	NIGHT	DAY	NOTE
--faint	rgba(214,224,242,.6)	rgba(22,38,75,.68)	legal, second half of a heading
--line	rgba(160,186,228,.16)	rgba(22,38,75,.13)	every hairline
--on-cream	#0d1930	same	ink on cream surfaces
--ink-blue	#35507f	same	meta, icons and notes on cream
--err	#a52c3e	same	
--err-ink	#8e2233	same	
--logo-bar	#7f9dd0	#6e88ab	
--logo-ink	#f1ead7	#213a5f	
--logo-tag	#93acd4	#5a6f98	
--sky-1	#36487f	#f8f1e3	
--sky-2	#26396d	#f5ecdb	
--sky-3	#1b2d5c	#f1e6d1	
--sky-4	#142548	same	
--haze-1	#a59aca	#9ca0d6	
--haze-2	#1e50a2	#7088a8	
--map-lo	#2b4a84	#f8f2e4	shortest and tallest columns
--map-hi	#a9c2ec	#e3d5b4	shortest and tallest columns

TOKEN	NIGHT	DAY	NOTE
--map-lit	#d8c8a2	#5679ab	the governorate in focus
--map-fill	#6f8fc1	#f4ead6	side light; light from above; light from below
--map-sky	#8ea6d4	#fffaf2	side light; light from above; light from below
--map-ground	#070d1c	#f0e6d0	side light; light from above; light from below
--lattice	#c5d2e8	#213a5f	grid lines; the cell under the pointer
--lattice-lit	#f1ead7	#213a5f	grid lines; the cell under the pointer
--c-bg		#f4ecdc	body ground
--c-raise		#fbf6ec	cards, bands, menus
--c-tint		#f7f0e2	a card one step off the raise
--c-deep		#ece1cb	page edge, footer, alternate band
--c-sand		#e4d5b6	reserved
--c-blue		#213a5f	
--c-blue-2		#2d4a72	
--c-blue-ink		#152a47	
--c-blue-deep		#182f50	foot of the inquiry band
--haze-3		#d6be8c	

Token index: type, shape, layout, motion.

The remaining tokens. Fluid sizes are written as the page uses them: a smallest size, a rate of growth with the screen, and a largest size.

TOKEN	NIGHT	DAY	NOTE
--serif	Newsreader,Iowan Old Style,Times New Roman,serif	same	headings, figures, statements
--sans	Fira Sans,system-ui,-apple-system,Segoe UI,sans-serif	same	everything else
--arabic	Cairo,system-ui,-apple-system,Segoe UI,sans-serif	same	replaces both in Arabic
--fs-body	17px	same	desktop; phones
--fs-body-sm	16px	same	desktop; phones
--fs-h1	clamp(2.7rem,5.5vw,5rem)	same	page title
--fs-hero	clamp(2.6rem,4.3vw,4rem)	same	the hero headline beside the map
--fs-h2	clamp(2.1rem,4vw,3.5rem)	same	section heading
--fs-h3	1.6rem	same	card heading
--fs-card-title	clamp(1.85rem,3.1vw,2.75rem)	same	practice card heading
--fs-statement	clamp(1.55rem,2.85vw,2.5rem)	same	the reading paragraphs
--fs-signoff	clamp(2rem,6.05vw,5.45rem)	same	footer line
--fs-figure	clamp(2rem,3.1vw,2.8rem)	same	numbers in the figures row
--fs-price	clamp(4rem,7.4vw,6rem)	same	the hourly rate
--fs-lede	1.12rem	same	hero paragraph
--fs-sub	1.1rem	same	paragraph under a section heading

TOKEN	NIGHT	DAY	NOTE
--r-card	20px	same	cards, panels, menus
--r-in	12px	same	inputs, menu rows
--r-btn	999px	same	everything you can press: buttons, nav links, toggles, chips
--r-tag	999px	same	small labels that cannot be pressed
--r-cover	6px	same	printed covers
--wrap	1280px	same	widest the content column gets
--gap	20px	same	between cards in a grid
--sec-y	clamp(100px,12vw,170px)	same	space above and below a section
--sec-head	clamp(40px,5vw,68px)	same	space under a section heading
--h-btn	54px	same	button heights
--h-btn-sm	42px	same	button heights
--ease	cubic-bezier(.22,.8,.26,1)	same	
--spring	cubic-bezier(.22,.8,.26,1)	same	replaced below by a true no-bounce spring where the browser can
--t-reveal	1.2s	same	content rising into view
--t-ui	.2s	same	hover and press feedback
--rise	48px	same	how far content rises as it arrives